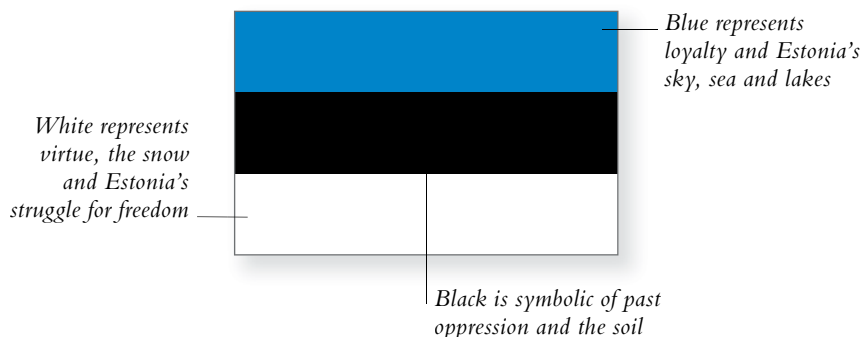


Estonia

Ratio: 7:11 **Adopted:** May 8, 1990 **Usage:** National and Civil



Europe



Estonia declared independence from the Russian Empire in 1918. In 1940 it was annexed by the Soviet Union, but recovered its independence in 1991.

The tricolor was first adopted by students in 1881 during uprisings against occupying Russian Tsarist forces. It was re-adopted as the national flag in 1990 just prior to independence. The colors represent Estonian history, folk costumes, and landscape. Blue is the color of loyalty and also represents the sky,

sea, and lakes. Black symbolizes the past suffering of the people, the soil and the traditional black peasant's jacket. White represents virtue and the struggle for freedom. It is also the color of birch bark and snow.

The great coat of arms was originally the emblem of a 13th-century Danish king.

GREAT ARMS OF ESTONIA

The shield is surrounded by golden branches of oak



Three blue leopards are ranged on a gold shield